



EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Finger Prints in India 2023, is the 27th annual publication in the series, highlighting the progress and achievements of the Central Finger Print Bureau (CFPB) and State Finger Print Bureaux (SFPBx) including the activities, initiatives undertaken, database status, trainings etc., during the calendar year 2023. This publication also presents other useful information such as relevant laws, equipment and relevant books, enabling the readers to equip themselves with the latest developments in the field.

Chapter I - ACTIVITIES OF CENTRAL FINGER PRINT BUREAU (CFPB)

In the calendar year 2023, a total of 802 new document cases were received from different Government agencies like CRPF, Post Offices, Staff Selection Commission, Banks, Railway Recruitment Boards, etc. Along with 14 cases pending from previous year, a total of 816 cases were available for examination. Finger Print Experts at CFPB examined and furnished their expert opinion in 647 cases during the year 2023.

NCRB has conceptualized and implemented National Automated Fingerprint Identification system (NAFIS) which is robust, secure and proving to be a game changer in the field of Finger Print identification. It enables “States/UTs/Law Enforcement agencies to upload, trace & retrieve criminal fingerprint data in real time on a 24X7 basis using the server placed at NCRB” for smoother expression. Central Finger Print Bureau (CFPB) has imparted training to the Finger Print experts of States/UTs for using the application. Subsequently, a large number of latent finger prints-hitherto untraced- received from SFPBx during past years have been processed by Finger Print experts of CFPB and SFPBx/ UTs through NAFIS. Currently, the NAFIS has been commissioned at 1377 locations covering all Districts, Police Commissionerates, State Finger Print Bureaux and Central LEAs like NIA, CBI and NCB & IB.

XXIV (24th) All India Conference of Directors of Finger Print Bureaux was organized on 20th and 21st September 2023 at National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB), New Delhi. Delegates from various Finger Print Bureaux, CFSL-DFSS, NIA, FSLs, students from various Colleges and Universities offering Forensic Science and Criminology course participated in the conference. All India Board Examination (AIBE) for Finger Print Experts 2023 was held from 19th to 21st August, 2023.

Chapter II - SIGNIFICANT CASES SOLVED BY STATE FINGER PRINT BUREAUX

Important cases solved by the Finger Print Experts of State Finger Print Bureaux are



highlighted in this chapter. After examination, States/UTs submitted 119 cases however only 71 cases were selected in this chapter for publication in this chapter based on their sensitivity, the value of property lost/recovered, and the detection of a series of cases etc.

The main responsibility of a Finger Print expert is to develop chance prints left by criminals at the crime scene and to match these with the finger prints in the criminal database to establish a link between the crime and the criminal. Further, Finger Print experts also receive fingerprint slips of arrested persons to provide their criminal antecedents by processing these in the finger prints database. In the year 2023, Finger Print Units of the SFPBx/Police/Other Staffs have visited 77,028 crime scenes and developed chance prints in 26,442 cases and a total of 62,794 chance prints were found fit for comparison. A total of 4382 cases have been solved through chance prints.

Chapter III - TRANSACTIONAL ACTIVITIES OF CFPB AND SFPBx

During 2023, States/UTs maintained a ten-finger prints database of **15,12,608** convicted and arrested persons. During 2023, CFPB examined 42 chance print cases in which **153** chance prints were traced and in **208** cases a final opinion was recorded in instances of differing opinions by the State Experts, through SuperLVQ.

A total of 1842 document cases were received in 2023 and 668 were pending in the previous year. A total of **1923** cases were examined by Finger Print experts, while 587 cases remain pending in the SFPBx. In **303** cases, Finger Print experts from various SFPBx deposed in the Courts of Law for testimonies. Following table shows the All India Statistics of the fingerprint transactions in States/UTs during 2023.

Transactional Activities of State Finger Print Bureaux				
Convict Slips Received	Arrestee Slips Received	FP Document Cases Received	Chance Print Developed (Fit for comparison)	Chance Print Cases Traced/Identified
132717	1379891	1842	62794	4382

Chapter IV - ANALYSIS OF FP TRANSACTIONAL ACTIVITIES

This chapter deals with the analysis of concomitant factors such as conviction rates, reasons for discrepancies in the data provided and inter-comparison of data procured from the State Finger Print Bureaux along with the depiction of major activities such as record slips, search slips, document cases, chance prints and also categorization of crimes under various heads at a glance.



The state of Madhya Pradesh recorded the highest number of fingerprint slips recorded in the year 2023 for conviction of criminals for grievous hurt, murder, attempt to murder, rape and assault on women. Punjab, Maharashtra and Haryana have recorded significant number of conviction slips. States such as Gujarat, Maharashtra and Madhya Pradesh recorded the highest number of arrestee slips and several other States including Haryana, Punjab, Tamil Nadu, Delhi, Karnataka, Odisha and Telangana recorded significant number of Finger Print Arrestee slips in proportion to their population and number of crime incidences. Tamil Nadu, Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh, Andhra Pradesh, Punjab, Maharashtra, Karnataka and Telangana have examined more than **100** document cases in the year 2023. Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh and Telangana States have topped the list with highest number of chance print cases identified in the year 2023. Further analysis revealed that record slips for individuals convicted of grievous hurt, murder, attempt to murder, and rape were the highest in number as compared to other IPC heads whereas the number of search slips recorded also showed a sharp rise for crimes such as attempt to murder, murder, kidnaping & abduction, assault on women and rape. In cases of property related crimes, the number of persons arrested and convicted for the offences of other IPC were higher than those involved in each of theft, burglary, forgery, cheating, fraud and robbery. The number of persons arrested and convicted under NDPS Act ranked second other Special and Local Laws (SLL) crimes.

Chapter V - NATIONAL AUTOMATED FINGERPRINT IDENTIFICATION SYSTEM (NAFIS)

This chapter gives information on various aspects of NAFIS software such as Introduction, work flow of NAFIS and status of NAFIS till 31st Dec 2023 in different States/UTs. Under the NAFIS Project, 1,377 work stations were provided to all SFPBx, Commissionerates & Districts and Central LEAs. CFPB/ NAFIS database had 92,84,811 ten-digit finger print slips of convicted, arrested and others as on 31st December 2023.

All India Statistics of the NAFIS status in States/UTs during 2023

No. of work stations Allotted	No. of workstations commissioned	NAFIS database size 2023	No. of users activated	Total No. of Chance Prints Traced
1,377	1377	92,84,811	3422	4023

Chapter VI- CAPACITY BUILDING

CFPB/NCRB organizes a numerous training and refresher courses for police officers staff of FPBx across India. This chapter provides information pertaining to capacity building and



various training programs conducted during the calendar year 2023.

Number of persons trained by CFPB		Number of persons trained by SFPBx	
At CFPB	At SFPBx/UTs	Own Staff Trained at SFPBx	Other Officials Trained at SFPBx
626	704	920	42979

ANNEXURE:

Useful information like pioneers of Finger Print Science, laws related to finger prints in India, staff posted in various Finger Print Bureaux, availability of different types of equipment in each States/UTs, list of AIBE toppers, standard books on Finger Print Science, contact details of State FPBx and list of NAFIS Nodal officers of various State/UTs are covered in the annexures part of this publication.



METHODOLOGY OF DATA COLLECTION AND CONTENT FORMATION

The Bureau publishes its annual report 'Finger Prints in India', which compiles statistical data on the performance and activities of States/UTs Finger Print Bureaux, CFPB, and other information related to Finger Prints. The process of publication of the annual report i.e. 'Finger Prints in India' consists of the following steps:

- i)** In the **3rd week of January, 2023**, a letter was sent to all the Finger Print Bureaux requesting to furnish the information about their activities in the standard Annual Statistics Report (ASR) form. It had the following details:
 - a)** Number of convicted persons' finger prints maintained at the State Finger Print Bureau at the beginning of the year, number of FP slips added in the year under consideration, FP slips received but returned to police stations due to errors, number of FP slips digitized and entered into NAFIS, number of FP slips eliminated.
 - b)** Similar information is received regarding arrested persons.
 - c)** Number of FP cases received at Finger Print Bureau seeking previous criminal records, number of cases traced, pendency at Finger Print Bureaux.
 - d)** Categories of offences for which finger prints were obtained at the State Finger Print Bureaux.
 - e)** Single Digit Section, Scene of Crime details, Documents Section (Govt. and others), Absconder Action/Death Reports.
 - f)** NAFIS details regarding its connectivity and functionality status in SFPBx along with availability of FP Live Scanner.
 - g)** Details of training courses being organised, its faculty strength and cross-section of officials attending it from police and non-police background.
 - h)** Organizational structure of existing FPBx of States/UTs including sanctioned strength, actual strength, vacancies and DFPB as well as source of allotment of funds to them.
 - i)** Summary of the milestones achieved by the Bureaux of States/UTs and suggestions for future developments.
 - j)** Information in connection with the crime data associated with finger prints, categorized under various crime heads such as; Murder (Section 302), culpable homicide not amounting to Murder (Section 304), Causing death by Negligence (Section 304-A), Dowry deaths (Section 304-B), Abetment to suicide (Section



305/306), Attempt to Murder (Section 307) & Culpable Homicide (Section 308), Grievous Hurt (Section 325, 326), Acid Attack (Section 326A, 326B). Assault on Women (Section 354, 354A, B,C,D), Kidnapping & Abduction (Section 363, 363A, 364, 364A, 366A, B & Section 365 to 369) Human Trafficking (Section 370, 370A, 372, 373), Rape (Section 376) etc.

- k)** Information on fingerprint (Record and Search) slips about Foreign Nationals committing crimes in India and also about Indians involved in crime abroad.
 - l)** Information about R&D activities taking place in the SFPBx.
 - m)** Chance Print (Scene of Crime) details describing a clear picture of chance print comparison happening in SFPBx and in districts. The table has a column to specify Chance Prints lifted by Finger Print staff, police personnel or other staff.
 - n)** Provision is made to furnish judgement details regarding important cases solved by SFPB.
 - o)** Information about finger print equipment available at state FPB or subordinate offices.
 - p)** Information on vehicles available for finger print work at state, district and police station levels is also introduced.
- ii)** Received information from various units was compared with the previous year information. Observed abnormalities were communicated to the respective unit with a request to validate/rectify.
- iii)** Based on the validated data, this publication is prepared.
- iv)** In chapter IV, analytical and graphical representations of transactional details of the States have also been presented for ease of comprehension and comparison.
